BUHLE PALAZA

Software Tester | QA Analyst

Gqeberha, Eastern Cape, South Africa | +27 60 484 4381 | palazabb@gmail.com
linkedin.com/in/buhle-palaza | github.com/BuhleB | Open to relocation, remote and hybrid work

PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

QA tester with a year of hands-on testing experience at CAPACITI across e-commerce, HR and payment systems. Experienced in manual testing, API validation, defect investigation and automated regression testing with Playwright, Selenium and pytest. Full-stack development experience helps me investigate issues beyond the interface and collaborate effectively with developers. Seeking a QA Analyst or Software Tester role in an Agile/Scrum team, with a focus on growing API testing and automation skills while working towards ISTQB CTFL certification.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Testing: Manual, functional, regression, integration, exploratory, usability and UAT; API testing; cross-browser and cross-device testing; performance and security checks; test planning, scenarios, cases, traceability and defect reporting.

Automation and tools: Playwright, Selenium WebDriver (Java/Python), TestNG, JUnit, pytest, Postman, Jira, ExtentReports, pytest-html and GitHub Actions.

Development: Python, Flask, SQLAlchemy, SQL, PostgreSQL, HTML, CSS, JavaScript, PHP, Laravel, REST APIs, Git and GitHub.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Software Tester Trainee | CAPACITI

August 2025 - August 2026 | Gqeberha | Hybrid contract

- Reviewed user stories, acceptance criteria and requirements to estimate testing effort and define test approaches, translating them into test plans, scenarios and regression packs in Jira with traceability.
- Executed manual, functional, integration, exploratory, performance and security checks across e-commerce, HR and payment systems, including cross-browser and cross-device testing.
- Performed backend and API testing with Postman and built, maintained and executed automated UI and backend regression suites using Playwright, Selenium WebDriver, JUnit and pytest.
- Identified, reproduced and logged defects in Jira with reproduction steps and evidence; performed retesting and regression checks to confirm fixes and obtain sign-off before closure.
- Worked in an Agile/Scrum team of 10, collaborating with developers and across departments, testing features during development and validating end-to-end workflows before deployment.
- Performed pre-launch QA and post-launch UAT spot checks to confirm release stability, and prepared documentation for team knowledge sharing.

Software Developer | Makwande Careers

January 2025 - June 2025 | Remote contract

- Architected, built and tested a career-services web application using Python, Flask, PostgreSQL and SQLAlchemy, with RESTful backend services and an HTML/CSS/JavaScript frontend.
- Delivered the business's first website and a centralised admin dashboard for enquiries, CV submissions and purchases, integrating Paystack payments and Resend transactional email.
- Implemented bcrypt password hashing, CSRF protection and input sanitisation; conducted end-to-end QA before go-live and configured GitHub Actions CI/CD with Render.
- Diagnosed and fixed membership submissions that appeared successful but were not saved to the database, and resolved a file-upload field mismatch blocking CV/document uploads.
- Improved admin dashboard load times by using Promise.all to run independent requests in parallel.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE CONTINUED

Systems Developer Intern | Loomee Group

September 2023 - August 2024 | Gqeberha | Hybrid contract

- Collaborated in a development team to build Forgot Password ROI, a web application displaying advertisements and capturing product interest during password recovery, using HTML, CSS, JavaScript, PHP and Laravel.
- Developed interactive forms for capturing product interest, email addresses and intended purchase dates, with fields displayed according to user selections.
- Implemented client-side validation using JavaScript and server-side validation using Laravel FormRequest rules.
- Contributed to password-reset and email workflows, tested form behaviour and navigation, investigated issues, and managed source code through GitHub.

EDUCATION

Diploma in Information Technology
Nelson Mandela University, Port Elizabeth | 2021 - 2025

Certificate of Achievement: N2 Engineering Studies
Port Elizabeth College | 2019

National Senior Certificate (Matric)
Khumbulani High School | Completed 2018

CERTIFICATION

Further Education and Training Certificate: Information Technology: System Development
MICT SETA | 2025

COURSES AND TRAINING

Software testing | Coursera | 2025
Foundations of Software Testing and Validation; Black-box and White-box Testing; Introduction to Automated Analysis; Introduction to Software Testing; Web and Mobile Testing with Selenium.

AI and machine learning | Coursera | 2025
AI Essentials; AI Foundations: Prompt Engineering with ChatGPT; Generative AI with Large Language Models; Introduction to Generative AI; Introduction to Responsible AI; Python for Data Science and AI; Trustworthy AI: Managing Bias, Ethics, and Accountability; Supervised Machine Learning: Regression and Classification; Advanced Learning Algorithms; Unsupervised Learning, Recommenders, Reinforcement Learning.

CURRENT PROFESSIONAL GOAL

Working towards ISTQB Certified Tester Foundation Level (CTFL) certification while deepening API testing and test automation skills.

AI IN TESTING AND DEVELOPMENT

Use AI tools to suggest edge cases from user stories and acceptance criteria, support debugging and understand unfamiliar technologies. Review suggestions against requirements, discard irrelevant outputs and verify changes through testing. Protect credentials and sensitive data; retain responsibility for defect classification and release-readiness decisions.

REFERENCE

Yonela Futho | Tech Mentor, CAPACITI | yonela@capaciti.org.za